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Decision-making/Problem Solving & Delegation Skills

September 18 and 29, 2023

Brighter Strategies

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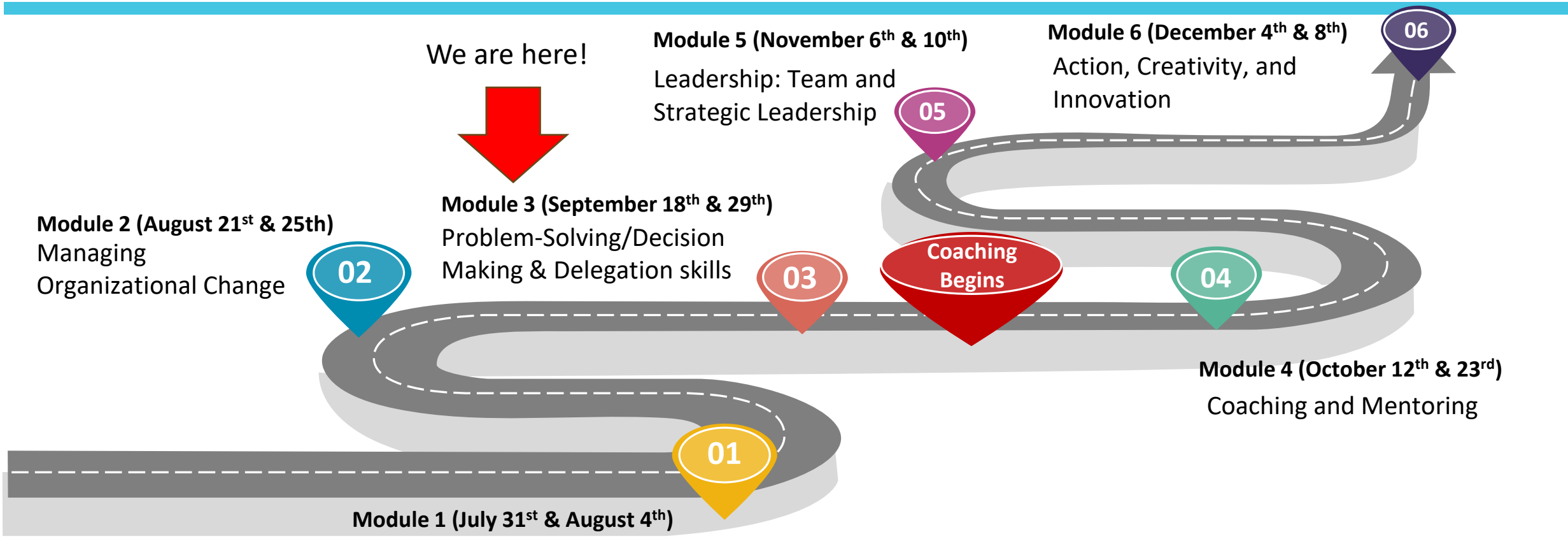
Our Roadmap



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Coaching Kick-off!

Instructions:

1. Read the flyer about Brighter Strategies coaches Jennifer, Dionne, Dawn, and Randall. Read more about each coach using the hyperlinks by clicking on each coach's name.

2. Using the calendar links at the bottom of the flyer, **schedule two 20-minute introductory calls** with the coaches of your choice.

3. After your meetings, email Fernanda at **Fernanda@brighterstrategies.com** with your selections of whom you would like to have as a coach. Please limit selections to your **top two choices**.

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Coaching Ground Rules

- Maintain mutual confidentiality
- Maintain mutual respect and trust
- Be honest
- Be present
- Engage in open and active communication
- Maintain a growth mindset during sessions- embrace challenges, learn from mistakes, and aim to improve continuously
- Be engaged and free of distractions (no email, phone, etc.)
- Align goal setting to competencies in POA's Competency Model

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Community Rules

- Strive for an open and dynamic conversation
- Use the chat, reactions, or other features to engage with others
- Cameras on! Request for the camera to be on whenever possible, especially in breakout rooms
- Permission to self-regulate (breaks, phone calls, speaking time, etc.)
- Have fun!
- Anything else?

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Today's Objectives

Learning Objectives:

1. Constantly develop informed, timely, effective decisions, distinguish between relevant and irrelevant information, and consult others when appropriate
2. Examine internal and external conditions to inform decision-making
3. Anticipate the consequences of decisions
4. Consider the long-term impacts of strategic decisions and choices that will impact the organization
5. Clearly define and communicate objectives and tasks

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Welcome back!

On a 1-5 scale how do you feel about decision making? (1 = Hate it; 5 = Love it)

Would anyone like to share a challenge they have faced around decision-making?

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Decision-making and Problem-Solving

- Problem solving and decision-making go hand in hand!
- Problem-solving involves gathering all the facts, asking questions, and finding related causes to land on a solution.
- Decision-making involves choosing a solution per your judgment, prior knowledge, facts, and more.

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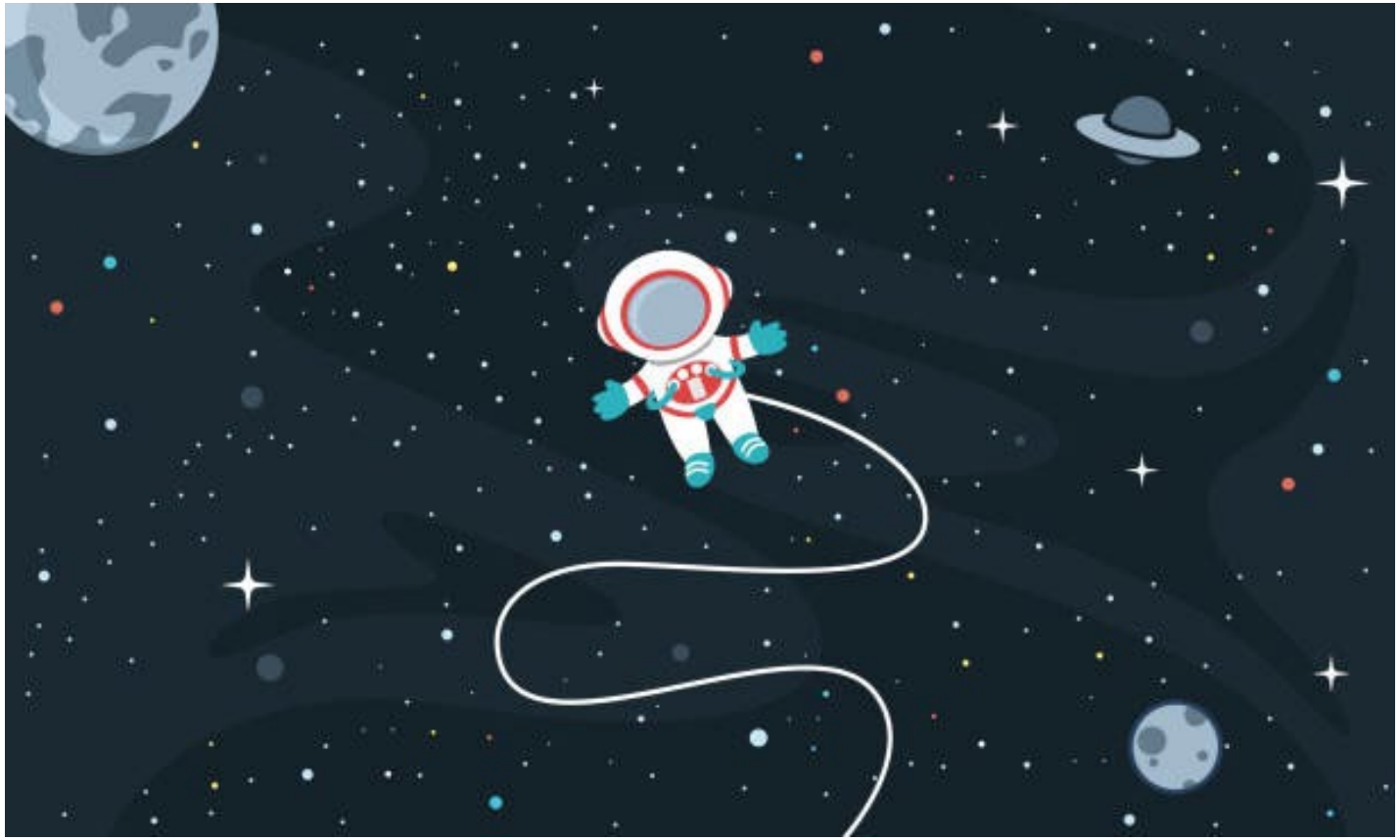
Activity! NASA Space Exercise



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Common Models of Decision-making

Garbage Can

Intuitive

Rational

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Garbage Can Model

- Elements of a decision:
  - Problems
  - Participants
  - Solutions
  - Choice opportunities
- Decision making process: factors float randomly inside the organization and if they connect, a decision results

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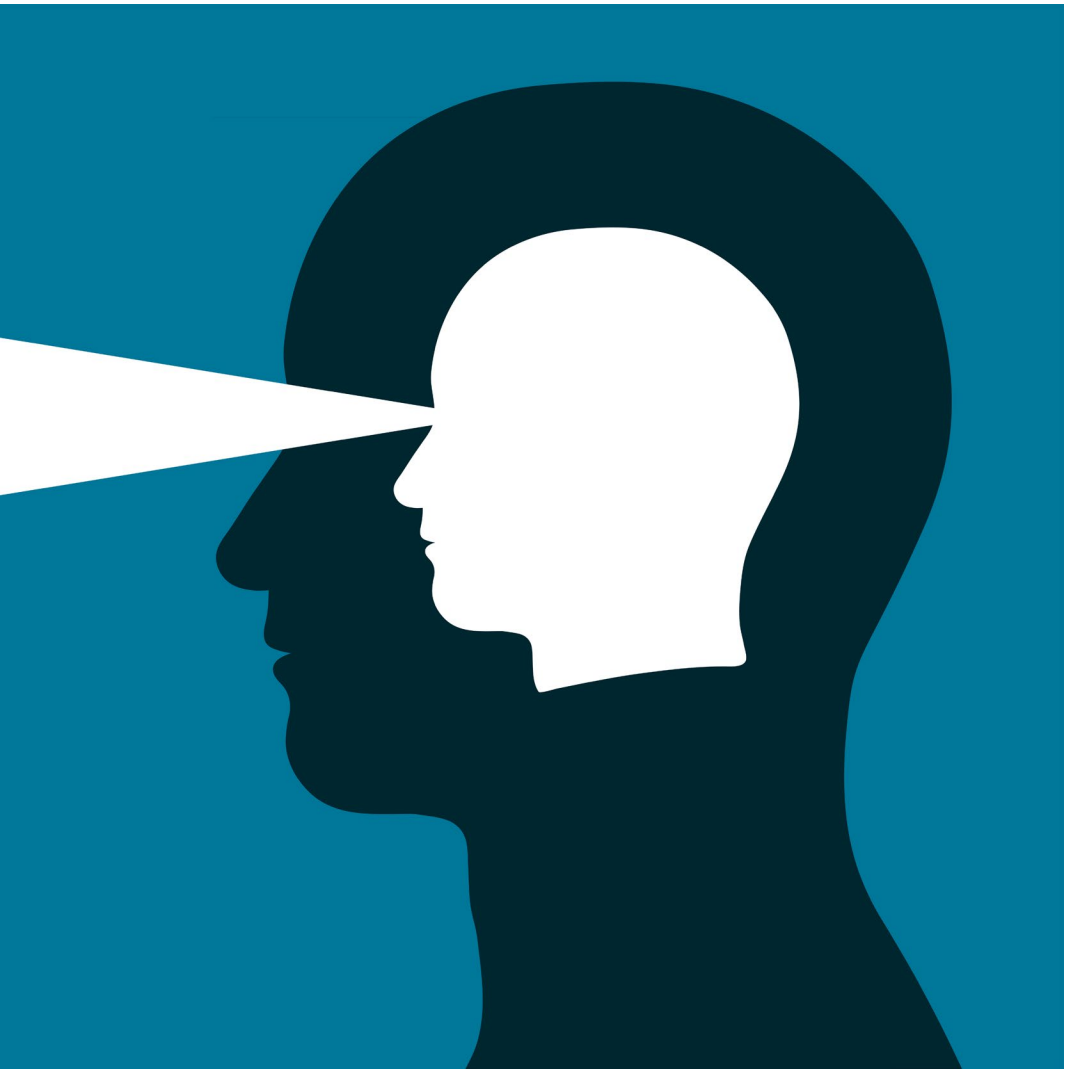

Intuitive Model

- Cognitive conclusion based on a decision maker's previous experiences and emotional inputs
- May lead one to favor some information over another

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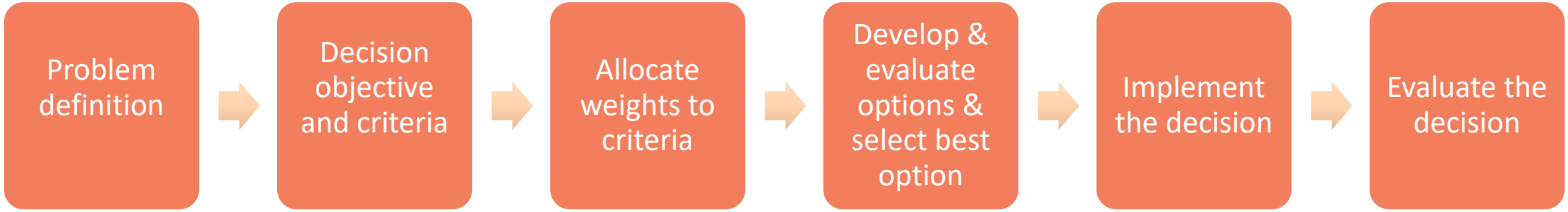
Rational Decision-making Model



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Group Dynamics & Decision-making

Common decision-making biases:

1. Availability cascade
2. Anchoring and adjusting
3. Bounded awareness
4. Emotional involvement
5. Overconfidence
6. Self-serving reasoning

Avoid groupthink!

- Groupthink is a mode of thinking in which individual members of small cohesive groups tend to accept a viewpoint or conclusion that represents a perceived group consensus, whether or not the group members believe it to be valid

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Discussion

Think about a recent decision you made…

- Identify the bias you held with regard to the situation or outcome
- How did the bias affect the outcome?
- Would you have made a different decision if you had acknowledged your bias and had mitigated the effects?
- How would you have mitigated the effects?

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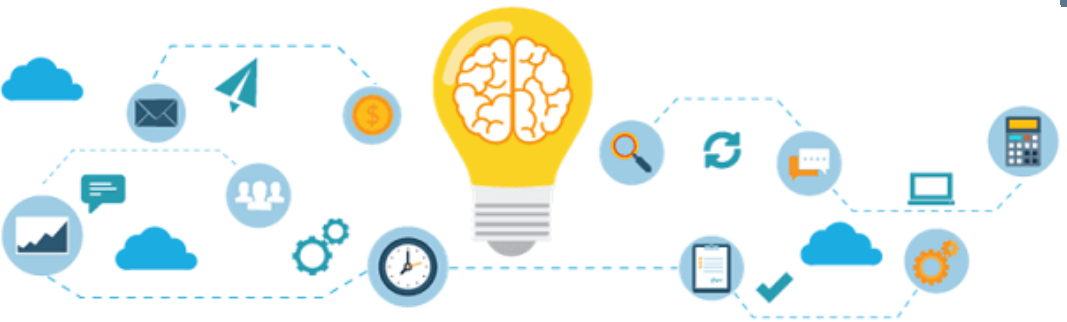
Things to Consider When Making Group Decisions:



1. Team competence
2. Group expertise
3. Group support for objectives
4. Likelihood for commitment
5. Decision significance
6. Importance of the commitment
7. Leadership expertise

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How To Avoid Groupthink

- Encourage all members to express their doubts
- Assign a devil's advocate
- Adopt the perspectives of other constituencies
- Bring in qualified outsiders to discuss decisions
- "Sleep" on a tentative decision and have a second chance meeting
- Leaders: listen to others' opinions first
- Leaders: demonstrate a willingness to be criticized

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Considerations for Group Decision-making

- What are the set of decisions for your team that lend themselves to majority votes?
- What are the kinds of decisions that will benefit from using consensus?
- Does any team member's vote have more "weight" than others?
- What role changes and new group rules will you need in implementing a variety of decision-making modes?
- What should the process be for revisiting decisions?
- Should proxy voting be permitted in the event that a team member cannot attend the meeting?

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Decision-making within Teams

- Review the decision-making process within your team – how do you do it now, and what techniques would you like to incorporate?
- What model (garbage can, intuition, rational) does your team most often adopt?
- What biases tend to influence your team's decisions?

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What is Delegation?

- Delegation refers to the transfer of responsibility for specific tasks from one person to another
- Delegation is an important opportunity for peer development

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Barriers and Benefits to Delegation

Delegation

Barriers

- Believe it is faster and easier to do it yourself
- Assume that the person you are delegating to will not do a high-quality job
- Hesitant to relinquish control & decision-making
- Sense of responsibility, thinking, “I should be doing this”

Benefits

- Allows managers to spend time on other responsibilities
- Develops an employee skills and abilities
- Increases peer confidence and motivation
- Empowers and builds trust

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An Empowering Leader…

- Practices knowledge sharing
- Delegates challenging assignments to others and coaches them to succeed
- Challenges others to higher levels of initiative and performance
- Encourages others to take the lead, make decisions and find their own path forward

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The Delegation Process

Identify	Identify tasks and responsibilities to delegate
Discuss	Discuss responsibilities and define success
Maintain	Maintain control
Provide	Provide consistent follow-up

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Discuss Responsibilities and Define Success

- Explain your reasons for delegating and the benefits to the employee
- Clarify the parameters for the responsibility and authority you are delegating
- Together, define the measures of success
- Ask employees to identify potential problems & obstacles and brainstorm solutions
- Identify the support you as a leader will provide to ensure success

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Maintain Control

- Discuss timelines & deadlines
- Review progress regularly
- Make adjustments as needed
- Review all submitted work

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Provide Consistent Follow Up

- Begin by asking, “What has happened since we last met?”
- Give positive, reinforcing feedback on what has gone well
- Address problems as necessary through skillful questioning
- Agree on the next steps and schedule follow-up

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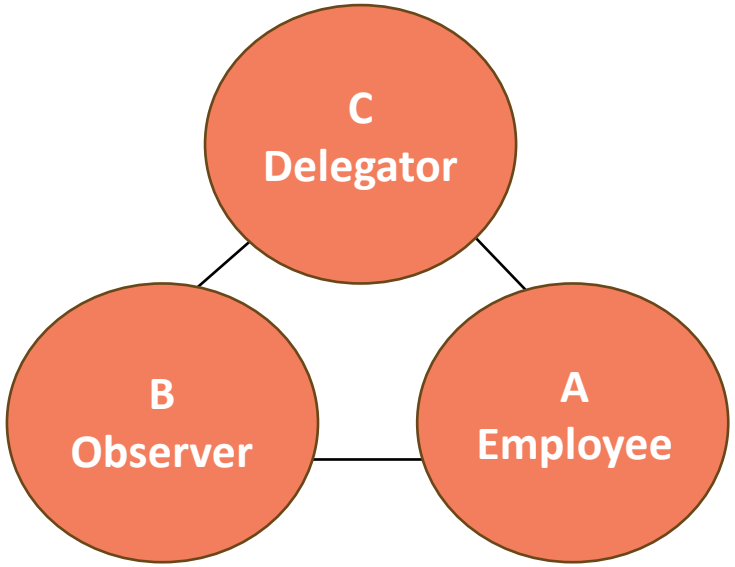
Delegation Activity- Role Play Exercise

- *Scenario*: Imagine that management in your company realizes how hard you are working and decides to appoint an assistant for you. It's great news, but it means you have to start delegating some of your work!



Key outcomes

- **Explain your reasons for delegating and the benefits to the employee.**
- **Clarify the parameters for the responsibility and authority you are delegating.**
- **Together, define the measures of success.**
- **Ask employees to identify potential problems & and obstacles and brainstorm solutions.**
- **Identify the support you as a leader will provide to ensure success.**

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Cautions

- Avoid “upward delegation”

  Attempts to give the work back to you because they say they can’t do it

- Do not to accept work that doesn’t meet your standards

- Avoid taking the work back because it does not initially meet your standards

- Budget enough time for reviews and revisions

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Any questions? Thoughts?

Thank You

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